

adaptive 2.8K OLED with an option to adjust the refresh rate between 48-120Hz. The laptop also has a super-fast 0.2ms response time. It's VESA certified with ClearMR 5000 technology. Moreover, it offers uniform luminosity and colour accuracy with 400 nits of SDR brightness and an average Delta E value of 2.8, with wide colour gamut coverage of 100% DCI-P3 and 150% sRGB. The screen also features a Corning Gorilla Glass for protection.

Overall, the screen is great for content consumption and creation. In terms of gaming, its 120Hz max refresh rate seems a bit low but most other 14-inch laptops, including non-gaming ones, feature a 120Hz refresh rate display only. The Alienware X14 R2, however, seems to be an exception here thanks to a 1600p 165Hz display.

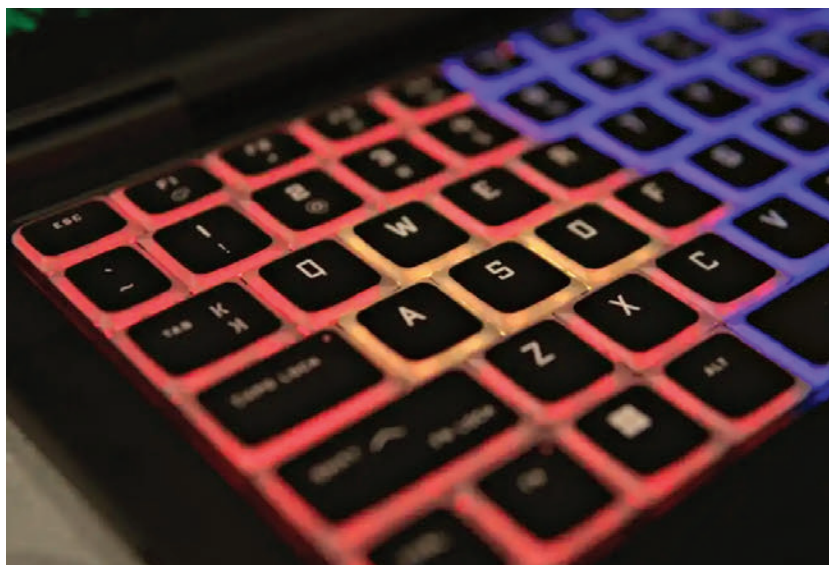
But the gaming experience remains pleasant on an Omen Transcend 14's display. The OLED panel accentuates deep blacks and produces vivid scenery, elevating the entire gaming experience.

As for the audio, HP employs dual HyperX-tuned speakers and they sound good. The speaker output is decently loud, and sharp, and has a decent tinge of bass as well. They are downwards facing, as is the case in most gaming laptops, and sound best when kept on a table.

GAMING PERFORMANCE, BATTERY LIFE AND BENCHMARKS

When it comes to performance, the HP Omen Transcend 14 leverages the prowess of the Intel Core Ultra 7 155H to deliver a solid gaming experience. Because let's face the facts, the 14-inch chassis was never going to run absolutely cool while gaming. Although the CPU package temperature does reach 90 degrees celsius in some cases, the surface temperature is very well maintained at around 42 degrees Celsius. Most of the time you will see this laptop maintain around 85 degrees while gaming at high settings.

In terms of power consumption, the laptop consumes around 68W in performance mode. However, the power consumption drops down to 15W when you're normally using the Omen Tran-



scend 14. However, don't put the laptop in ECO mode or best power efficiency mode as that renders the device too slow to use. But it tremendously improves battery life.

However, with everything set to max, the battery life takes a huge hit lasting only around 2.5 hours. You can extend the battery backup to around 5.3 hours by putting the laptop in balanced mode. I found the best setting for higher battery life – Integrated graphics turned ON with balanced power mode in Windows and Omen gaming hub, in this way, you can extract about 7.8 hours of battery life. In short, you can extract good battery life, you'd just have to figure out how.

Moving on to the benchmarks, the HP Omen Transcend 14 impressed me in 3d Mark's TimeSpy and Firestrike. Scoring almost as good as the 115W RTX 4060 powered Lenovo LOQ. In the crystal disk mark SSD speed test, the HP Omen Transcend 14 also delivered good read and write speed as well. Meanwhile, in gaming performance, the laptop echoed a similar conclusion. It is trailing behind the Lenovo LOQ by a small margin. Overall, the HP Omen Transcend 14's GPU, with its limited 65W TGP, can still manage to deliver solid performance.

Considering that the laptop maintains a moderate temperature even during intense gaming sessions, the combination of an Intel Core Ultra 7 CPU and an RTX 4060 GPU appears to be highly effective.

CONCLUSION

The HP Omen Transcend 14 redefines the delicate balance between sleek design and powerhouse performance in the gaming laptop arena. It successfully carves out a niche for itself by offering a compelling combination of high-end internals wrapped in a portable and aesthetically pleasing package. Despite facing stiff competition, it manages to shine, particularly with its impressive thermal management, vibrant 2.8K OLED display, and robust selection of I/O ports. The old adage, "You can't have your cake and eat it too," doesn't seem to apply here; the HP Omen Transcend 14 proves you can enjoy high-performance gaming on a device that's also easy on the eyes and light in the backpack. In short, this laptop is a testament to HP's ability to push the boundaries of what's possible in the thin and light gaming laptop market.

–Yetnesh Dubey

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Intel Core Ultra 7 155H featuring a dedicated NPU, 16-cores, 22-threads with a 4.8GHz boost clock | Graphics: Nvidia GeForce RTX 4060 | RAM: 16GB LPDDR5X RAM | Display: 2.8K 14-inch OLED display with 120Hz max refresh rate | Storage: 1TB PCIe Gen 3 SSD | Weight: 1.6kg

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